Could You Find Dad's Records if a Medicaid Application Ever Asked for Them?

Fourteen quick questions about what your family knows and can find. At the end: what you know, what's still unclear, and what to ask.

Answer yes, no or not sure, from wherever you're sitting. This checks how complete your family's picture of Dad's records is. It doesn't measure Dad's finances, and nothing here says anything about whether he would qualify for any program or whether anyone should apply.

1. Could you find Dad's identity and residency papers: the ones that show who he is and where he lives?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

2. Do you know where his Social Security and other income paperwork is kept?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

3. Could you find recent statements for each of his bank accounts, on paper or online?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

4. Could you find the records for any investment or retirement accounts he has?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

5. Do you know where his insurance policies are kept?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

6. Do you know where the deed to his home and any other property records are?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

7. Do you know whether Dad has a trust or an annuity, and where the papers are if he does?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

8. Are the larger money events of recent years written down with their dates: a sale, a gift, a large deposit or withdrawal?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

9. Is there a set way that new statements are kept as they arrive, on paper or online?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

10. Does someone besides Dad know where his records are kept?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

11. Has your family said who would handle an application if one were ever needed?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

12. Do you know which professional your family would contact for help?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

13. Do you have a general idea of how the application process works and where applications are submitted in Dad's state?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

14. Have you written down your questions about what would indicate it is time to apply?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

Answer the questions above and your page builds here.

WHAT YOU KNOW

WHAT'S STILL UNCLEAR

QUESTIONS TO CLARIFY

What this doesn't do

It counts what your family knows and can find, not what Dad has or what any of it means. A low count means there are things to look for, and most of them are a conversation with Dad or a look through a drawer away. Nothing here says which records his state would ask for, whether he would qualify for anything, or whether anyone should apply, and nothing here is legal, financial or tax advice.

Ready for the next step?

You can see which of Dad's records you could put your hands on and which you'd have to look for. The planning interview asks about your family's situation and gives you a free planning report you can bring to any conversation about paying for care. Keep the page you just copied beside you while you answer.

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